ABERDARE TECHNICAL COLLEGE

UNIT OF COMPETENCE:COMPUTER ESSENTIALS

UNIT CODE: 0611 351 01A

PRACTICAL 1,TERM 1

ELEMENT COVERED:2 MANAGE DESKTOP SETTINGS

TOTAL:50 MARKS

Name: _____ Reg. No: _____ Date: _____

Time: 2 Hours

A. Objectives

By the end of this practical, you should be able to:

- *Customize desktop icons and apply the date and time settings.*
- *Change the desktop background, theme, taskbar and menus.*
- *Adjust the text size and screen brightness to suit user needs.*

B. Materials and Requirements

- *A desktop computer or laptop running Windows 10 or Windows 11.*
- *A mouse and keyboard.*
- *A user account with permission to change personal settings.*
- *A folder named practical pictures, provided by the instructor, containing at least three image files.*
- *Applications installed: Notepad, Calculator and File Explorer.*
- *This practical sheet and a pen for recording your observations.*

C. General Instructions

- *Attempt ALL tasks in the order given and follow each instruction carefully.*
- *Write your observation in the space provided after each task.*
- *Call the instructor to check and sign off each task before you move to the next.*
- *Do not change any setting that is not mentioned in this practical. Use the Settings app and the Help feature of the computer to find the options you need.*
- *At the end, complete Task 9 to restore the computer to its original state.*

Task 1: Customize Desktop Icons

(a) Change the size of the desktop icons to Large, then to Medium.

(b) Arrange the desktop icons by Name, then by Date modified.

(c) Make sure the desktop displays the This PC, Recycle Bin and Network icons.

(d) Create a new folder on the desktop named PRACTICAL followed by your name, and place one icon inside it.

(e) Rename any one desktop icon, then change it back to its original name.

Task 2: Date and Time Settings

(a) Open the date and time settings of the computer.
(b) Set the time zone to your current location.
(c) Display the time in 24-hour format and the short date in the format dd/MM/yyyy.
(d) Make sure the computer is set to update its date and time automatically, and synchronize it.

Task 3: Background Colour and Pictures

(a) Change the desktop background to a solid colour of your choice.
(b) Change the desktop background to a picture of your choice and set it to fill the screen.
(c) Use a picture from the practical pictures folder provided by your instructor as your final desktop background.

Task 4: Themes

(a) Apply two different built-in themes, one after the other, and observe the changes in colours, sounds and background.
(b) Switch the computer between Light mode and Dark mode and observe the effect on windows and menus.
(c) Choose the theme you prefer and leave it applied.

Task 5: Taskbar

(a) Add Notepad or Calculator to the taskbar, then remove it.
(b) Set the taskbar to hide automatically, observe how it behaves, then turn the setting off.
(c) Change the alignment of the taskbar icons (Left or Center) and observe the change.
(d) Hide the Search and Task View buttons from the taskbar, then display them again.

Task 6: Menu Bar

(a) Open the Start menu, pin any application to it, then unpin the application.
(b) Open Notepad and identify the items on its menu bar. Open each menu.
(c) Open File Explorer and display its menu options for viewing files.
(d) Show file name extensions and hidden items, then hide them again.

Task 7: Text Size (2.3.5)

(a) Increase the size of the text on the screen.

(b) Observe the change in text across the Settings window, File Explorer and Notepad.

(c) Return the text size to its original default value.

Observation: Write the text size percentage you used and the effect it had on the screen.

Task 8: Brightness

(a) Set the screen brightness to its lowest level, then to its highest level.

(b) Set the brightness to a comfortable level of about 60%.

Observation: State the final brightness level you set.

Task 9: Restore and Clean Up

(a) Restore the original theme, background, taskbar alignment, text size and brightness settings.

(b) Delete the PRACTICAL folder you created on the desktop and empty any items you moved.

(c) Close all open applications and hand over the computer ready for the next user.